

AAILEEN SARWAR SYED

Chicago, IL | aaileenuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/aaileensyed | Portfolio: aaileenssyed.github.io/website

IT Support Analyst | Network Support Technician | NOC Technician | SOC Analyst Tier 1 | Junior Cybersecurity Analyst

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity M.S. graduate and early-career IT/network professional with hands-on experience in technical support, Windows systems, VPN and remote access troubleshooting, DNS/DHCP, LAN connectivity validation, endpoint monitoring, documentation, and escalation workflows. Building a network-first cybersecurity profile through CCNA preparation, Wireshark labs, TryHackMe practice, AuditReady AI, GitHub Actions CI/CD, and a secure infrastructure home lab with pfSense, Windows Server/Active Directory learning, Linux services, IDS/SIEM planning, vulnerability scanning, and monitoring workflows. Known for clear technical writing, customer-focused communication, and translating troubleshooting evidence into practical next steps for technical and non-technical audiences.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

IT Support & Systems: Windows 10/11, macOS familiarity, Linux Ubuntu/Kali, Microsoft 365, Outlook, Teams, remote desktop, laptop/desktop support, endpoint troubleshooting, ticket documentation, escalation notes, user support, onboarding support concepts

Networking: TCP/IP, LAN/WAN, VLANs, subnetting, DNS, DHCP, VPN, routing/switching fundamentals, Cisco router/switch exposure, firewall rule logic, network troubleshooting, Wireshark, Nmap

Security & Monitoring: Least privilege, access control, endpoint alerts, IDS/IPS concepts, vulnerability scanning exposure, OpenVAS, Nessus exposure, Snort exposure, PRTG, Sophos, Webroot, incident response documentation

Cloud, DevOps & Automation: Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, CI/CD workflow validation, Vercel deployments, PowerShell, Python, SQL, AWS/Azure exposure, documentation, change tracking

AI, Analysis & Communication: Claude 101, Google AI Studio, AI-powered search evaluation, prompt engineering, product feedback, Excel, Power BI, Pandas, Matplotlib, technical presentations, TEDx Speaker

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Analyst Intern | eFusion Solutions | Hoffman Estates, IL (Remote) | Oct 2022 - Jan 2023

- Resolved 30+ weekly support tickets involving Windows systems, applications, remote access, VPN connectivity, endpoint security alerts, and network troubleshooting.
- Assisted with Cisco router/switch troubleshooting, LAN connectivity validation, IP assignments, DNS, DHCP, VPN, firewall logic, and remote desktop support across client environments.
- Configured and monitored 15+ client environments using PRTG, Sophos, and Webroot to support uptime, endpoint visibility, alert review, and infrastructure reliability.
- Reviewed monitoring evidence, endpoint alerts, and troubleshooting logs to document incidents, root-cause findings, escalation notes, and resolution steps.
- Supported senior network administrators during network deployments, workstation setups, remote configuration, and structured escalation/change workflows.

Graduate Assistant | Office of Community Engagement and Experiential Learning, Lewis University | Romeoville, IL | Jan 2025 - May 2026

- Supported multi-user academic and operational systems for 200+ students each semester, including records, reporting, access guidance, process troubleshooting, and documentation.
- Troubleshoot access, connectivity, platform, and workflow issues while documenting procedures and escalating when needed for operational consistency.
- Maintained Collaboratory records and the Master Course List, improving tracking accuracy, documentation quality, and accessibility for staff and students.
- Created onboarding/reflection materials, newsletters, and process communications that improved partner engagement and participation.

Google Search Priority User Program | Google | Remote | Apr 2025 - Present

- Selected for a Google user research and feedback program focused on emerging AI-powered Search features, digital discovery experiences, and large-scale information systems.
- Evaluate new AI-driven experiences and provide structured feedback on usability, relevance, user behavior, output quality, and search experience reliability.
- Communicate product observations and improvement suggestions clearly to support product teams and represent a diverse user perspective in AI and UX innovation.

UI/UX Design Intern | Ikigai: The Art of Living | Hyderabad, India | May 2022 - Jul 2022

- Co-designed website UI in Figma and improved clarity, accessibility, and navigation through usability testing and competitor analysis.

PROJECTS

AuditReady AI - Compliance Readiness Platform | Independent Project | Vercel / GitHub | 2026

- Built and deployed a compliance readiness platform on Vercel to help users assess readiness across NIST CSF, HIPAA, PCI DSS, SOC 2, ISO 27001, and CIS Controls.
- Implemented a GitHub Actions CI workflow to install dependencies and validate production builds on every push and pull request.
- Used Git workflows, Vercel deployment logs, and build testing to troubleshoot deployment issues and improve release confidence.
- Documented framework scope, assessment flow, readiness scoring, evidence needs, policy gaps, risks, and remediation roadmap concepts.

Secure Infrastructure Home Lab | Independent Lab Series | VMware / pfSense / Windows / Linux | In Progress

- Designing a reusable small-business lab with segmented Employee, Server, Security, and Guest/Test LAN zones using pfSense routing and firewall logic.

- Planning phased deployment of Windows Server, Active Directory, Windows client, Ubuntu services, Kali testing host, IDS/SIEM tooling, vulnerability scanning, and NOC-style monitoring.
- Documenting architecture, IP addressing, asset inventory, security zones, firewall rules, troubleshooting steps, risk observations, and incident response notes.

Network Traffic Analysis: DNS, TCP Handshake & HTTPS Flow | Wireshark Lab | Networking / Troubleshooting | Completed

- Captured and analyzed DNS resolution, TCP 3-way handshake behavior, and HTTPS/TLS traffic using Wireshark to understand normal network flow and troubleshooting evidence.
- Performed DNS troubleshooting by intentionally misconfiguring DNS settings and validating symptoms with nslookup, ping, and packet observations.

AI-Assisted Firewall Rule and Network Security Policy Generator | Lewis University | Security / Linux / AI | 2026

- Built an educational tool that converts plain-English server/network requirements into Linux iptables firewall rules using a default-deny model.
- Generated explicit allow rules for SSH, HTTP, HTTPS, and ICMP while explaining risk level, business purpose, and least-privilege reasoning.

CYBERSECURITY COMPETITIONS, LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY

- 3rd Place, Advanced Track - Capture the Flame CTF, University of Illinois Chicago, Apr 2026; completed practical challenges across forensics, OSINT, analysis, and security problem solving.
- National Cyber League / Cyber Skyline - ranked 466 out of 6,981 nationally; participated in practical security challenges across individual and team events.
- TEDxLewis University 2026 Speaker - delivered a talk on international student hiring barriers, communication, and opportunity.
- President, Girls Who Code Lewis Chapter - organized coding workshops, security/networking fundamentals sessions, speaker-led events, and weekly co-working/networking hours.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Cybersecurity, Lewis University, May 2026, GPA: 3.9/4.0

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU Hyderabad, India, May 2024, Graduated with Honors

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Completed: Claude 101 Certification | Cisco Cyber Defense Analyst | IBM and ISC2 Cybersecurity Specialist | Data Analyst
Google AI Professional Certificate | Google Cloud Cybersecurity Professional Certificate | IBM Systems Analyst Professional
Certificate | Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate modules

In Progress: Cisco CCNA; CompTIA Security+; ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) - Candidate; Akamai Network Engineering
Professional Certificate

ONGOING TECHNICAL PRACTICE

Daily / Weekly Practice: TryHackMe rooms for Linux, networking, SOC fundamentals, web security, and practical security workflows;
LeetCode for Python problem solving, data structures, algorithms, and interview readiness.